TRENDS & TECHNOLOGY TIMELINE 2010+

A roadmap for the exploration of current & future trends
(+ some predictions to stir things up. More at nowandnext.com)

TIME ZONES

- ZONE 1: 2010-2015
- ZONE 2: 2015-2020
- ZONE 3: 2020-2025
- ZONE 4: 2025-2035
- ZONE 5: 2035-2050

Notes on time travel

This map is a broad representation of some of the trends and technologies currently visible. Improvement works are carried out at weekends and travellers should check to see whether lines are still operable before commencing any journeys. Helpful suggestions concerning new routes and excursions are always welcome.

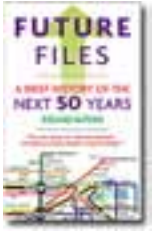
If you wish to travel outside of Zone 1 you are advised to bring comfy shoes and a camera. Travellers are also advised to bring their own supplies of food and water although weapons are unnecessary if you keep to well trodden paths. Also note that travel into Zone 5 is not available for people aged over 75 years of age.

A3 and A2 Prints of this map

Full colour prints of this map are available to anyone that asks nicely. A small charge is levied to cover print and postage costs only. Contact <richard@nowandnext.com> stating whether you'd like A3 or A2 size and saying which country the map is to be delivered to. Delivery is available to anywhere in the world. Alternatively, just print this out yourself (A3 minimum recommended)

Sourced

Material for this map has been soured from a number of publications including Future Files and What's Next



www.futuretrendsbook.com

What's Next
www.nowandnext.com

Acknowledgements

This map was conceived and created by Richard Watson at Nowandnext.com with some help from Benjamin Frazer at Snap. Also thanks to Oliver Freeman, Mike Jackson and Scott Martin.

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Digital cash widely embedded in human body
Single global e-currency
Animals suing humans
Convergence of healthcare and financial planning
Contents of British Library available on a postage stamp-sized chip
Digital cash widely embedded in clothing
Global population hits 9 billion
Brain drain from hedge funds to scientific R&D (energy #1 priority)
Wealth asylum seekers
Most people have multiple presences
Baby licences
Growth of 'Tech-No' movement
Online funerals
Search for meaning (Mondays to Fridays only)
Desire for control
Digital celebrities
Personal resp
Letter
Calorie taxes
Food passports
10-mile diets
Convenience
Indulgence
Authenticity
Well-being
Provenance
Rise of N11 countries
Rising levels of autocracy
Government e-services
Growth of state contr
Emergence of Gross National Happiness metrics
Whole life financial planning linked to whole family model
Growth of bartering
Growth of micro-insurance
Business sustainability largest determinant of stock price
First Internet court
Online communities start physical communities
Genetically enhanced pets
Emergence of Gross National Happiness metrics
Power shift Eastwards
75-year mortgages
Pre-pay currency cards
Micro-finance
Monolines
Speech recog
EDLP
Retirement
Figurative revolution in the arts as neoclassicism returns
Bionic Olympics
Last CD is published
e-ink comes of age
Paper statements & bills
Face recognition
Widespread cuts in public services
Free-tailing
Conspicuous non-consumption
women behav
Infrastructure under-investmen
Nuclear p
A graphic novel wins the Booker Prize
Acute labour shortages in aged-care sector
Synthetic biology
Life story labelling
Urbanisation
Move to global pricing of consumer goods (driven by shopbots)
Just-in-time shopping
Too much choice
Blurring of sectors
Sensory experiences
Disappearance of checkouts
Robocops in shopping malls
Local shopping
Price polarisation (High / Low)
Localism
Virtual libraries
Device convergence
Increasing interest rates
Blurring of scientific disciplines
Stored value car
Malicious intent detectors
Online micro-payments
Pets outnumber people globally
Digital mirrors
Basic forms of AI
Growth of security algorithms
Micro-finance
Robot population surpasses human population
High Street Internet addiction clinic
Mind control toys
Personalisation
Use of fake information as a weapon
P2P len
Mobile paym
Healthca
Average lifespan 100 years
Unexpected increase in fertility rates
Death of distance
Health & safety hysteria
Information pandemics
Empathy
'Spinning disk' memory devices
Full concentration
Home/work convergence
Basic forms of AI
Web 2.0
Volatility
Societal feminisation
Simplicity
Unsupe
Home swap holidays
Cloud storage
Machines that can judge emotional state of user
Increasing regulation & compliance
T.I.M
Rob
Devices re-programming themselves in light of experience
25% of company HQs now virtual
Widespread use of brain scans in job interviews
Single person households
Tightening security
Contactless payments
Binge drin
Online video
Micro-blogging
Digitalisation
Virtual currencie
Physical newspapers become luxury items
Near extinction of quality journalism spawns philanthropic funding
Digital diets
Growth in passenger numbers
Constant digital distraction
Prediction markets
Telepresence
Online medical records
Green IT
Domestic tourism
Voluntourism
Childcare robots
Face recognition doors
Quiet paint
4 billion mobile phone subscribers
Medical tourism
Intelligent packaging
Sustainability
Fair trade
Wireless re-charge
Low-cost competition
Shifting centres of economic activity
Cyber-pet vets
Video wallpaper
Aged care robots
Holographic storage
Wind power
Outsourcing backlash
Space tourism
Green cities
Slow food
Cautious optimism
Consumer e-health
Dining Rooms
Computers with moving parts
Modesty
Verbal search
Ocean dead zones
Green buildings
Comfort foods
CHIME liquidity
Sustainable tourism
Affective computing
Ubiquitous computing
Nano-solar
Global hospital brands
End of low-cost inputs
Eco-cynics
Gen X start to outlive their offspring
Most people have 2+
Fuel-cell phones
Skills shortages bi
Augmented reality contact lenses
Phone spam
Wearable computers
Human organ farms
Resources increasingly acquired on a no questions asked basis
Con
DNA computing
Global sensor network
Urban (vertical) farming
Male birth control pill
Digital nomads
Focus on hardware reduces as services more distributed and interoperable
Rise of the vegetarians
Creation of new arable lands as planet warms up
Plastic bones
Artificial livers
Quantum computing
Declining water quality
No more anonymous email addresses (one email address per person)
Peak water
Genetic diets
Privacy
All babies implanted with GPS & ID chips
80%
Global migration drift to warming parts of the northern hemisphere
Individual energy/carbon monitoring leads to allowances and/or tiered costing based on system akin to personal
Food allergies eliminated
Micro-scale health-bots
Space solar power
Meditation/holistic services bundled with medical procedures
Spray on surgical glo
Creation of Department of alcohol, firearms, soft drinks and confectionary (mandatory health warnings on all alcohol, junk food and candy)
Russia (demographically)
Optimism about the future

Global risks*

- Commodity price spikes
- Raw materials shortages
- Mass migration of population
- Nuclear terrorism
- Internet brownouts
- Electricity shortages
- Rapid increase in cyber crime
- Critical infrastructure attack
- Rogue stakeholder
- WMD Proliferation
- Green energy bubble
- Genetic terrorism
- Collapse of US dollar
- Global supply chain disruptio
- Terrorist attack on urban wat

*Low probability/high impact events that could derail any of the above trends and predictions